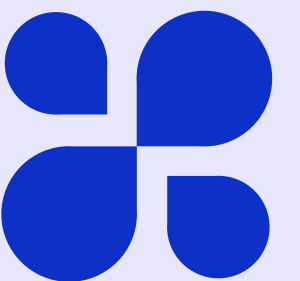




Language & Style

ARW (EA-115)

Ms Hamna Jafri

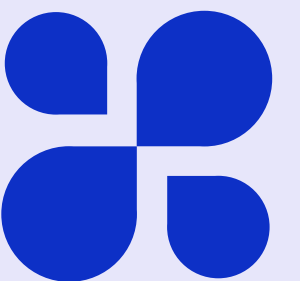




STYLE

Style might be considered as everything that gives a particular text its unique and individual 'flavour'. The ingredients that make up style will include:

- form: the shape, organisation and overall structure of the text
- language: the vocabulary, grammar, syntax, variety of sentences, choice of tense, register and so on.





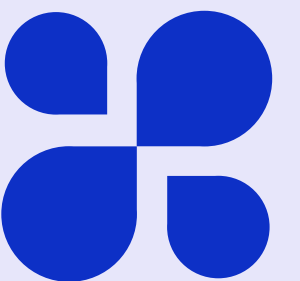
To understand the particular style and language of a text, or that a writer employs,

it is also helpful for you to explore:

- the purpose of texts (which may be explicit or implied), for example to persuade, inform, or describe

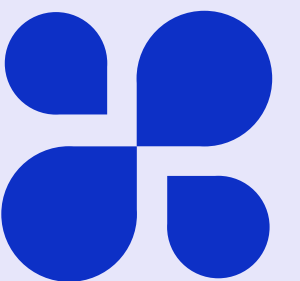
- the audience or reader at whom the text is aimed (which can be specific or general)

- the context of the text, for example when, where and how it was produced.



Do:

- read the text at least twice
- list or highlight key words and phrases from the text before you begin to write
- start your commentary with a clear, brief introduction in which you offer an overview or framework for your interpretation of, or commentary on, the set passage
- focus on what the writer **does** (the techniques he or she uses) and the **features** presented
- describe the **effects** of those techniques and features on the reader
- support what you say with well-chosen, **selective evidence** and **apt quotation**
- write in a **coherent, fluent** way which **links** rather than lists ideas
- keep your focus on style and language
- check your work as you write and tweak or adapt carefully to make sure your expression is succinct, yet sufficiently detailed.



Don't:

- start writing before you have read the text properly
- simply list or highlight everything in the text (!) – be selective
- **assert** an idea or opinion without supporting evidence
- simply 'feature-spot' – that is, point out a technique or a language device without explaining its effect or purpose (for example, mention that the writer has used alliteration without saying what its effect is)
- just summarise what happens or paraphrase without offering any commentary or interpretation
- list points or ideas in an unconnected way
- drift off into discussing aspects outside the question set.

Sample Responses

- A On the whole, this is an easy-to-read passage in which the writer uses short and long sentences to good effect. It is a direct and descriptive account of how an animal was shot. The writer lets the readers get acquainted with the scene and the atmosphere. The writer uses *if* clauses which add variety.
- B Orwell gives a direct, straightforward account in broadly chronological order, establishing the setting and then the events that ensue. He demonstrates the thought-processes he went through at the time, using *if* clauses to consider the consequences of what he might do, for example, saying *If he charged, I could shoot ...* to explain how the situation would be taken out of his hands.

A cluster of colorful confetti in the top-left corner, consisting of small, elongated, rounded rectangular shapes in shades of yellow, orange, pink, and green.

Thank you!

A cluster of colorful confetti in the bottom-right corner, consisting of small, elongated, rounded rectangular shapes in shades of yellow, orange, pink, and green.